

# SARAH M. JENKINS, SHRM-SCP

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## EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

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Visionary and high-impact Senior HR Executive with over 9 years of leadership experience overseeing global human resources operations for Fortune 500 organizations and high-growth technology sectors. Expert in transforming HR departments from administrative cost centers into strategic business engines. Proven success in architecting scalable talent acquisition frameworks, designing competitive total rewards programs, and fostering inclusive corporate cultures that drive employee retention and high performance. Specialized in post-merger integration (M&A), large-scale workforce restructuring, and the implementation of advanced HRIS solutions (Workday, SAP SuccessFactors). A trusted advisor to C-suite executives on organizational health, executive compensation, and succession planning.

## CORE COMPETENCIES & HR EXPERTISE

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- **Strategic Planning:** Organizational Design, Succession Planning, M&A Integration, Change Management, Crisis Management.
- **Talent Management:** Global Talent Acquisition, Employer Branding, Performance Management, Executive Search, Workforce Planning.
- **Employee Relations:** Conflict Resolution, Labor Law Compliance (EEOC, FLSA, FMLA), Workplace Investigations, Union Negotiations.
- **Total Rewards:** Compensation Modeling, Benefits Administration, Equity/Stock Option Planning, Wellness Programs, Executive Pay.
- **Learning & Development:** Leadership Coaching, Skill Gap Analysis, Onboarding Optimization, Diversity & Inclusion (DEI).
- **HR Technology:** Workday, Oracle HCM, BambooHR, Lever/Greenhouse ATS, Tableau for People Analytics, ADP GlobalView.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### Chief People Officer | Nexus Financial Group | Chicago, IL

*March 2021 – Present*

- **Global HR Strategy:** Design and execute the people strategy for a diverse workforce of 2,500+ employees across North America, EMEA, and APAC.
- **Culture Transformation:** Spearheaded a "Culture First" initiative that increased Employee Net Promoter Score (eNPS) from +12 to +54 within 18 months.
- **Strategic M&A:** Orchestrated the HR integration of three high-profile acquisitions totaling \$450M, ensuring 95% retention of key technical talent.
- **Workforce Analytics:** Developed a data-driven "People Dashboard" using Tableau, leading to a 20% reduction in voluntary attrition through predictive modeling.
- **Executive Coaching:** Directly advise the CEO and Board of Directors on executive compensation, board governance, and long-term leadership sustainability.

- **Compensation Overhaul:** Redesigned the corporate bonus structure to align with ESG (Environmental, Social, and Governance) goals.

### **Senior Director of HR | TechStream Solutions | Austin, TX**

*June 2017 – February 2021*

- **Hyper-growth Scaling:** Scaled the organization from 150 to 900 employees in under three years while maintaining culture and hiring quality.
- **Performance Systems:** Replaced traditional annual performance reviews with a "Continuous Feedback" model, boosting engagement scores by 35%.
- **DEI Leadership:** Established the company's first Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion committee, achieving a 40% increase in URM representation at leadership levels.
- **Global Mobility:** Managed the setup of international legal entities and payroll systems in the UK and Germany, ensuring GDPR and local law compliance.
- **Budget Management:** Managed a \$15M annual HR budget, delivering 5% under budget through process automation and vendor consolidation.

### **HR Business Partner (HRBP) | Zenith Manufacturing | Detroit, MI**

*August 2014 – May 2017*

- **Labor Relations:** Primary point of contact for union negotiations and disputes, maintaining zero work stoppages over a 3-year period.
- **Policy Development:** Authored a comprehensive Employee Handbook and Code of Conduct adopted by 12 regional plants and 5,000 employees.
- **Training Programs:** Developed a "Frontline Supervisor" training program that reduced workplace safety incidents by 25%.
- **Talent Pipelines:** Partnered with local universities to create an engineering internship program that served as the primary source for 40% of entry-level hires.

## **HR CASE STUDIES & STRATEGIC PROJECTS**

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### **Case Study: Global HRIS Implementation (Workday)**

**The Challenge:** Nexus Financial Group was using disparate, localized payroll and HR systems in five different countries, leading to massive data inaccuracies.

**The Solution:**

- **Phased Rollout:** Led a 14-month global implementation of Workday HCM and Payroll.
- **Change Management:** Conducted specialized training sessions for over 200 managers globally.
- **Result:** Achieved "One Source of Truth" for global headcount data; reduced payroll processing time by 40%.

## Case Study: Post-Acquisition Cultural Integration

**The Challenge:** Following a major acquisition, the parent company's hierarchy clashed with the startup's agile style, causing a spike in resignations.

### **The Solution:**

- **Strategy:** Implemented a "Best of Both Worlds" integration plan, retaining startup autonomy for R&D.
- **Execution:** Introduced "Integration Buddies" and weekly pulse surveys.
- **Result:** Attrition normalized within 4 months; the acquired team delivered their primary milestone 2 months early.

## EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL CREDENTIALS

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### Education

#### **Master of Business Administration (MBA)**

Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University | 2014

*Concentration: Organizational Behavior and Human Resources*

#### **Bachelor of Science in Psychology**

Michigan State University | 2011

### Professional Certifications

- SHRM Senior Certified Professional (SHRM-SCP)
- Senior Professional in Human Resources (SPHR)
- Global Professional in Human Resources (GPHR)

## DETAILED HR DEEP DIVES

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### Employee Engagement & Retention Strategies

- **Recognition Programs:** Design of "Spot Awards" and peer-to-peer recognition systems.
- **Feedback Loops:** Implementing quarterly "Stay Interviews" for high-potential (HiPo) employees.
- **Wellness Initiatives:** Holistic health programs covering mental, physical, and financial well-being.

### Legal Compliance & Risk Mitigation

- **Audit Preparedness:** Conducting internal HR audits to ensure I-9, FLSA, and payroll compliance.
- **Policy Agility:** Rapidly updating remote work policies to comply with evolving state laws.
- **Investigation Mastery:** Conducting unbiased, thorough internal investigations regarding sensitive issues.

### Total Rewards & Compensation Philosophy

- **Benchmarking:** Utilizing Radford and Mercer data to ensure 50th-75th percentile market positioning.
- **Equity Design:** Structuring RSU and Option pools for executive and broad-based employee grants.
- **Benefit Innovation:** Introducing non-traditional benefits like fertility coverage and unlimited PTO.

## EXECUTIVE MANAGEMENT & BOARD INTERACTION

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- **Board Reporting:** Presenting quarterly updates on human capital risk and ESG progress.
- **Compensation Committee:** Collaborating with consultants to design executive "Pay-for-Performance" packages.
- **Crisis Management:** Leading HR responses to organizational crises, including data breaches.

## INDUSTRY CONTRIBUTIONS & VOLUNTEERING

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- **Board Member:** Chicago HR Strategy Forum.
- **Mentor:** "HR Open Source" for startup HR founders.
- **Volunteer:** Career coaching for military veterans.

## CAREER MILESTONES BY YEAR

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- **2014-2015:** Mastering the fundamentals of labor relations and compliance.
- **2016-2017:** Leading regional initiatives and policy standardization.
- **2018-2019:** Scaling high-growth tech firms and performance systems.
- **2020-2021:** Navigating remote-work transitions and global operations.
- **2022-Present:** Driving strategic M&A and executive leadership.